

Introduction

We know one size doesn't fit all, but do hundreds of sizes fit all? A question for philosophers, so we'll leave it for them to answer. What we're hinting at is that there are hundreds of CMS systems out there, but we know there is a CMS-shaped hole in your heart that can only be filled by something you create yourself. Well, we have you covered.

Creating a CMS may be the goal of this booklet, but as the saying goes, the journey is more important than the destination. In learning how to create a CMS we will explore the popular open source web framework Django, and Python, the language it is built on. Even if your heart is content with existing CMS systems, you should hopefully find these technologies interesting and applicable to your needs.

We pick the popular open source Django framework because it provides the right mixture of features, performance and ease for our case.

In this booklet, we start with the basics of Python, to accommodate those who have never programmed in it before, but some knowledge of programming, and web technologies (mostly HTML) is essential. Once you're familiar with Python, we'll move on to the Django framework. After introducing the framework we will then consider the design of our CMS, and how best to utilise Django in achieving that design. While developing each piece of functionality we will also take a deeper look into the features of Django that power them.

The best way to use this booklet is to follow along on your computer. If you find that some code is unclear, or does not work, chances are that the snippet of code you just typed in needs to be in the right context. We've made all code snippets available (in their correct context) online on GitHub for your reference. You can find the snippets by following this shortlink:

<http://dgit.in/snipcoderep>